

BEGINNER INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

1. What is Windows Server 2022?

Windows Server 2022 is Microsoft's enterprise-grade server operating system. It is used to manage users, networks, security, virtualization, and enterprise services. It provides advanced security and hybrid cloud capabilities.

2. What is the main purpose of a Server Operating System?

A server operating system is designed to provide centralized services such as authentication, file sharing, and application hosting. It supports multiple users simultaneously and ensures security, scalability, and reliability.

3. What are the editions of Windows Server 2022?

Windows Server 2022 comes in Standard, Datacenter, and Datacenter Azure Edition. Standard is suitable for basic virtualization, while Datacenter supports unlimited virtualization and advanced features.

4. What is Active Directory?

Active Directory is a directory service used to manage users, computers, and resources centrally. It provides authentication, authorization, and policy-based management in a Windows domain environment.

5. What is a Domain?

A domain is a logical group of computers and users managed centrally using Active Directory. It allows administrators to apply security policies and manage resources from a single point.

6. What is a Domain Controller?

A Domain Controller is a server that hosts Active Directory services. It authenticates users, enforces security policies, and manages access to domain resources.

7. What is DNS in Windows Server?

DNS (Domain Name System) resolves domain names into IP addresses. In Windows Server, DNS is critical for Active Directory functionality and network communication.

8. What is DHCP?

DHCP (Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol) automatically assigns IP addresses and network configuration to devices. It reduces manual configuration and prevents IP conflicts.

9. What is NTFS?

NTFS (New Technology File System) is a Windows file system that supports permissions, encryption, compression, and large files. It is more secure and reliable than FAT-based systems.

10. Difference between FAT32 and NTFS?

FAT32 does not support file permissions or large files beyond 4GB. NTFS provides advanced security, reliability, and supports very large files.

11. What is a Local User?

A local user account exists only on a single computer. It cannot access domain resources unless explicitly permitted.

12. What is a Domain User?

A domain user is created in Active Directory and can log in to any computer within the domain. Permissions and policies are centrally managed.

13. What is Group Policy?

Group Policy is a feature used to control user and computer settings. It helps enforce security policies and standardize configurations across the domain.

14. What is a GPO?

A Group Policy Object (GPO) is a collection of policy settings. It is linked to sites, domains, or OUs to apply configurations.

15. What are FSMO roles?

FSMO (Flexible Single Master Operations) roles handle critical Active Directory tasks. They prevent conflicts in multi-DC environments.

16. How many FSMO roles are there?

There are five FSMO roles: Schema Master, Domain Naming Master, RID Master, PDC Emulator, and Infrastructure Master. Each role performs a specific function.

17. What is the Schema Master role?

Schema Master controls changes to the Active Directory schema. It ensures consistency of object definitions across the forest.

18. What is the RID Master role?

RID Master assigns unique Relative IDs to Domain Controllers. These IDs are used to generate unique SIDs for objects.

19. What is the PDC Emulator role?

PDC Emulator handles password changes, time synchronization, and legacy authentication. It plays a critical role in domain stability.

20. What is the Infrastructure Master role?

Infrastructure Master updates cross-domain object references. It ensures that group memberships remain accurate.

21. What is a Forest in Active Directory?

A forest is the highest-level Active Directory structure. It contains one or more domains that share a common schema and trust.

22. What is a Tree in Active Directory?

A tree is a group of domains that share a contiguous namespace. All domains in a tree have transitive trust relationships.

23. What is an Organizational Unit (OU)?

An OU is a logical container used to organize users, computers, and groups. It helps apply Group Policies efficiently.

24. Why are OUs important?

OUs allow delegation of administrative control. They also help in applying targeted Group Policies.

25. What is LDAP?

LDAP (Lightweight Directory Access Protocol) is used to query and modify directory services. Active Directory uses LDAP for communication.

26. What is Kerberos authentication?

Kerberos is a secure authentication protocol used in Active Directory. It uses tickets instead of passwords to reduce security risks.

27. What is an SID?

A Security Identifier (SID) uniquely identifies a user, group, or computer. Windows uses SIDs to manage permissions.

28. What is User Account Control (UAC)?

UAC is a security feature that prevents unauthorized system changes. It prompts for approval when administrative actions are required.

29. What is Server Manager?

Server Manager is a centralized console to manage server roles and features. It allows administrators to monitor and configure servers.

30. What is the difference between a Role and a Feature?

A role provides a primary server function like AD or DNS. A feature supports roles, such as .NET Framework.

31. What is a File Server?

A file server provides centralized storage for users. It allows controlled access and secure file sharing.

32. What is a Print Server?

A print server manages printers and print jobs centrally. It simplifies printer deployment and management.

33. What is IIS?

IIS (Internet Information Services) is a web server platform from Microsoft. It hosts websites and web applications.

34. What is Port 80 used for?

Port 80 is used for HTTP traffic. It transmits data without encryption.

35. What is Port 443 used for?

Port 443 is used for HTTPS traffic. It provides encrypted and secure communication.

36. What is RDP?

RDP (Remote Desktop Protocol) allows remote access to a server or system. Its default port is 3389.

37. What is MMC?

MMC (Microsoft Management Console) is a framework for administrative tools. It allows snap-ins like ADUC and DNS.

38. What is Event Viewer?

Event Viewer displays system, security, and application logs. It is used for troubleshooting and auditing.

39. What is System State Backup?

System State Backup includes AD, registry, boot files, and system files. It is essential for AD recovery.

40. Why are Windows Updates important?

Windows Updates fix security vulnerabilities and bugs. They help keep the server secure and stable.

41. What is RAID?

RAID combines multiple disks to improve performance or fault tolerance. It protects data against disk failure.

42. What is RAID 0?

RAID 0 improves performance by striping data. It provides no fault tolerance.

43. What is RAID 1?

RAID 1 mirrors data across disks. It provides redundancy and data protection.

44. What is RAID 5?

RAID 5 uses parity for fault tolerance. It requires at least three disks.

45. What is BitLocker?

BitLocker encrypts entire disks to protect data. It prevents unauthorized access if the disk is stolen.

46. What is Windows Firewall?

Windows Firewall controls incoming and outgoing network traffic. It helps protect the server from attacks.

47. What is an Inbound Firewall Rule?

Inbound rules control traffic coming into the server. They allow or block connections based on rules.

48. What is an Outbound Firewall Rule?

Outbound rules control traffic leaving the server. They help restrict unauthorized connections.

49. What is PowerShell?

PowerShell is a task automation and scripting tool. It is used for advanced server management.

50. Difference between CMD and PowerShell?

CMD is command-based, while PowerShell is object-oriented. PowerShell is more powerful and flexible.

51. What is Hyper-V?

Hyper-V is Microsoft's virtualization platform. It allows running multiple virtual machines on one server.

52. What is a Virtual Machine?

A virtual machine is a software-based computer. It runs its own operating system and applications.

53. What is Host OS?

Host OS runs on the physical server. It manages hardware and virtualization.

54. What is Guest OS?

Guest OS runs inside a virtual machine. It is isolated from the host system.

55. What is a Snapshot?

A snapshot captures a VM's state at a point in time. It is used for testing and rollback.

56. What is a Checkpoint in Hyper-V?

A checkpoint is Hyper-V's version of a snapshot. It saves the VM's state temporarily.

57. What is a Virtual Switch?

A virtual switch connects VMs to networks. It enables internal, external, or private networking.

58. What is NAT?

NAT translates private IPs to public IPs. It allows internal devices to access external networks.

59. What is an IP Address?

An IP address uniquely identifies a device on a network. It enables communication between systems.

60. Difference between IPv4 and IPv6?

IPv4 uses 32-bit addresses, while IPv6 uses 128-bit addresses. IPv6 supports a much larger address space.

61. What is a Subnet Mask?

A subnet mask separates network and host portions of an IP address. It helps in network segmentation.

62. What is a Default Gateway?

A default gateway routes traffic outside the local network. It is usually a router.

63. What is Loopback Address?

The loopback address is 127.0.0.1. It is used to test local network functionality.

64. What is the Ping command?

Ping tests network connectivity. It checks if a system is reachable.

65. What is Ipconfig?

Ipconfig displays IP configuration details. It is used for network troubleshooting.

66. What is Netstat?

Netstat shows active network connections. It helps in diagnosing network issues.

67. What is Tracert?

Tracert traces the route packets take to a destination. It helps identify network delays.

68. What is Nslookup?

Nslookup is used to query DNS records. It helps troubleshoot DNS issues.

69. What is Task Manager?

Task Manager monitors running processes and performance. It helps manage system resources.

70. What is a Service in Windows?

A service is a background process. It starts automatically or manually.

71. What is Automatic Service Startup?

Automatic services start during system boot. They are essential for core functions.

72. What is SID History?

SID History allows permission retention during migrations. It helps in seamless access.

73. What is a Trust Relationship?

A trust allows users from one domain to access resources in another. It enables cross-domain access.

74. What is One-Way Trust?

One-way trust allows access in a single direction. Only one domain trusts the other.

75. What is Two-Way Trust?

Two-way trust allows mutual access. Both domains trust each other.

76. What is GPMC?

GPMC is Group Policy Management Console. It manages GPOs centrally.

77. What does gpupdate /force do?

It refreshes Group Policies immediately. Both user and computer policies are reapplied.

78. What does gpresult /r do?

It displays applied Group Policies. It helps verify policy application.

79. What is RSOP?

RSOP shows resultant policies applied. It helps troubleshoot GPO conflicts.

80. What is Backup?

Backup is a copy of data for recovery. It protects against data loss.

81. What is Restore?

Restore recovers data from backup. It is used during failures.

82. What is Shadow Copy?

Shadow Copy stores previous file versions. It allows quick recovery.

83. What is SMB?

SMB is a file sharing protocol. It allows network file access.

84. What port does SMB use?

SMB uses port 445. It is essential for file sharing.

85. What is NTLM?

NTLM is an older authentication protocol. It is less secure than Kerberos.

86. Kerberos vs NTLM?

Kerberos is more secure and efficient. NTLM is legacy-based.

87. What is SID Filtering?

SID filtering prevents unauthorized SID usage. It enhances security in trusts.

88. What is an ACL?

ACL defines permissions for objects. It controls access rights.

89. What are NTFS Permission Types?

Read, Write, Modify, and Full Control. They define user access levels.

90. What is Permission Inheritance?

Inheritance allows child objects to receive parent permissions. It simplifies management.

91. What is Least Privilege?

Least privilege means granting minimum access. It reduces security risks.

92. What is Audit Policy?

Audit Policy tracks user activities. It helps in security monitoring.

93. What is an Event ID?

Event ID identifies a specific log entry. It helps in troubleshooting.

94. What is a Blue Screen?

A blue screen indicates a system crash. It usually occurs due to driver or hardware issues.

95. What is Patch Management?

Patch management ensures systems are updated. It fixes vulnerabilities.

96. What is WSUS?

WSUS manages Windows updates centrally. It controls update deployment.

97. What is a Time Server?

A time server synchronizes system clocks. It is essential for authentication.

98. Why is Time Synchronization important?

Kerberos authentication requires accurate time. Time mismatch causes login failures.

99. What is Startup Type?

Startup type defines service behavior. Examples are Automatic and Manual.

100. What is Safe Mode?

Safe Mode loads minimal drivers. It is used for troubleshooting.

Intermediate

101. What is an Authoritative Restore?

An authoritative restore forces restored Active Directory objects to replicate to other Domain Controllers. It is used when specific AD objects need to be recovered and overwritten across the domain.

102. What is a Non-Authoritative Restore?

In a non-authoritative restore, the restored Domain Controller updates itself from other DCs. It is used for normal recovery when AD data is still available elsewhere.

103. What is Active Directory Recycle Bin?

The AD Recycle Bin allows administrators to recover deleted AD objects without restoring from backup. It preserves attributes and group memberships.

104. What is SYSVOL?

SYSVOL is a shared folder that stores Group Policy files and scripts. It is automatically replicated across Domain Controllers.

105. What is FRS?

FRS (File Replication Service) is a legacy SYSVOL replication method. It has been replaced by DFS Replication due to reliability issues.

106. What is DFS Replication?

DFS Replication is a modern and efficient file replication service. It ensures consistent data across multiple servers.

107. What is a Global Catalog?

The Global Catalog contains partial information about all objects in the forest. It helps users quickly locate resources across domains.

108. What port does Global Catalog use?

Global Catalog uses port 3268 for LDAP queries. For secure queries, it uses port 3269.

109. What is a DNS Forwarder?

A DNS forwarder sends unresolved DNS queries to another DNS server. It improves name resolution efficiency.

110. What is a Conditional Forwarder?

A conditional forwarder forwards DNS queries for specific domains. It is useful in multi-domain or partner environments.

111. What are DNS Zone Types?

DNS zone types include Primary, Secondary, and Stub zones. Each serves a different role in name resolution and replication.

112. What is an AD-Integrated DNS Zone?

An AD-integrated DNS zone is stored in Active Directory. It replicates automatically with AD and provides better security.

113. What is DNS Aging and Scavenging?

DNS aging tracks unused records, and scavenging removes them automatically. It prevents DNS clutter and conflicts.

114. What is a DHCP Scope?

A DHCP scope defines a range of IP addresses. It also includes lease duration and options.

115. What is a DHCP Lease?

A DHCP lease is the duration an IP address is assigned to a device. After expiry, it must be renewed.

116. What is a DHCP Reservation?

A DHCP reservation assigns a fixed IP to a specific device. It is based on the MAC address.

117. What is a DHCP Superscope?

A superscope combines multiple DHCP scopes. It is used when a subnet needs more IP addresses.

118. What is DHCP Split Scope?

Split scope divides IP allocation between two DHCP servers. It provides redundancy without failover configuration.

119. What is APIPA?

APIPA automatically assigns an IP in the 169.254 range. It occurs when DHCP is unavailable.

120. What is WINS?

WINS resolves NetBIOS names to IP addresses. It is a legacy service and rarely used today.

121. What is AD Sites and Services?

AD Sites and Services manage replication topology. It optimizes traffic between locations.

122. Why are AD Sites important?

Sites control replication based on network speed. They reduce bandwidth usage.

123. What is Intersite Replication?

Intersite replication occurs between different AD sites. It is scheduled and compressed.

124. What is KCC?

KCC automatically generates replication topology. It ensures efficient replication paths.

125. What are Linging Objects?

Linging objects are outdated AD objects. They occur when replication fails for a long time.

126. What is USN Rollback?

USN rollback is a replication failure scenario. It causes inconsistencies between DCs.

127. What is Tombstone Lifetime?

Tombstone lifetime defines how long deleted objects remain. It helps prevent replication issues.

128. What is the default Tombstone Lifetime?

The default tombstone lifetime is 180 days. After this, deleted objects are permanently removed.

129. What is System State Backup?

System State Backup includes AD, registry, and system files. It is essential for AD recovery.

130. What is Bare Metal Recovery?

Bare Metal Recovery restores an entire server. It includes OS, applications, and settings.

131. What is Volume Shadow Copy Service?

VSS allows consistent backups of open files. It is used by backup applications.

132. What is DFS Namespace?

DFS Namespace provides a logical file path. It simplifies access to shared folders.

133. What is DFS Replication used for?

DFS Replication synchronizes files between servers. It ensures data availability.

134. What is SMB Signing?

SMB Signing ensures secure communication. It prevents tampering.

135. NTFS vs Share Permissions – which takes priority?

The most restrictive permission applies. NTFS permissions always apply locally.

136. What is Access-Based Enumeration?

ABE hides files users don't have access to. It improves security and usability.

137. What is an IIS Application Pool?

An application pool isolates web applications. It improves stability and security.

138. What is a Worker Process?

A worker process executes IIS applications. It runs under w3wp.exe.

139. What is an SSL Certificate?

An SSL certificate encrypts web traffic. It ensures secure communication.

140. Self-Signed vs CA Certificate?

Self-signed certificates are for testing. CA certificates are trusted publicly.

141. What is Windows Defender?

Windows Defender provides built-in malware protection. It runs in real time.

142. What is Event Forwarding?

Event forwarding sends logs to a central server. It helps in monitoring.

143. What is Audit Success and Failure?

Audit success logs allowed actions. Audit failure logs denied actions.

144. What is PowerShell ISE?

PowerShell ISE is a scripting environment. It helps write and debug scripts.

145. What is Execution Policy?

Execution policy controls script execution. It prevents unauthorized scripts.

146. Common Execution Policies?

Restricted, RemoteSigned, Unrestricted, and Bypass. Each defines script permissions.

147. What is a Scheduled Task?

A scheduled task runs actions automatically. It supports triggers and conditions.

148. What is Performance Monitor?

Performance Monitor tracks system performance. It helps identify bottlenecks.

149. What is a Performance Bottleneck?

A bottleneck limits system performance. It could be CPU, memory, disk, or network.

150. What is Paging File?

Paging file acts as virtual memory. It helps manage RAM usage.

151. What is NIC Teaming?

NIC teaming combines network adapters. It provides redundancy and performance.

152. What is Switch Independent Mode?

Switch independent mode works without switch configuration. It offers flexibility.

153. What is Hyper-V Replica?

Hyper-V Replica provides VM replication. It supports disaster recovery.

154. Replica vs Backup?

Replica is a live copy. Backup is point-in-time.

155. What is a Checkpoint Merge?

Checkpoint merge occurs when a snapshot is deleted. Data merges into the base disk.

156. What is a Generation 1 VM?

Generation 1 uses BIOS-based boot. It supports legacy systems.

157. What is a Generation 2 VM?

Generation 2 uses UEFI boot. It supports secure boot and faster startup.

158. What is Secure Boot?

Secure Boot prevents unauthorized boot loaders. It enhances security.

159. What is Dynamic Memory?

Dynamic memory adjusts RAM usage automatically. It improves resource utilization.

160. What is NUMA?

NUMA optimizes CPU and memory access. It improves performance in large systems.

161. What is Windows Admin Center?

Windows Admin Center is a web-based management tool. It manages servers centrally.

162. What is Server Core?

Server Core is a minimal installation option. It reduces attack surface.

163. Benefits of Server Core?

Lower resource usage and better security. It has fewer updates.

164. How to manage Server Core?

Server Core is managed via PowerShell. Remote tools are also used.

165. What is RSAT?

RSAT allows remote server management. It includes AD and DNS tools.

166. What is Patch Window?

Patch window is scheduled update time. It minimizes downtime.

167. What is Update Rollback?

Rollback removes problematic updates. It restores stability.

168. What is Blue-Green Deployment?

Blue-green deployment reduces downtime. It switches traffic between environments.

169. What is NTP?

NTP synchronizes system clocks. It is critical for authentication.

170. Why does PDC Emulator sync time?

PDC Emulator ensures domain time accuracy. Kerberos depends on it.

171. What is Log Shipping?

Log shipping replicates logs for recovery. It supports disaster recovery.

172. What is Network Quarantine?

Network quarantine isolates devices. It protects the network.

173. What is RODC?

RODC is Read-Only Domain Controller. It is used in branch offices.

174. Benefits of RODC?

Improved security and reduced risk. It limits credential exposure.

175. What is Password Replication Policy?

PRP controls credential caching on RODC. It enhances security.

176. What is Smart Card Authentication?

Smart cards use certificates for login. They provide strong security.

177. What is a BitLocker Recovery Key?

The recovery key unlocks encrypted drives. It is used during recovery.

178. What is TPM?

TPM stores encryption keys securely. It enhances BitLocker security.

179. What is a Secure Channel?

Secure channel enables trust communication. It authenticates domain members.

180. What is NLTEST?

NLTEST checks domain trust and connectivity. It is a troubleshooting tool.

181. What is DCDIAG?

DCDIAG tests Domain Controller health. It detects AD issues.

182. What is REPADMIN?

REPADMIN manages and troubleshoots replication. It provides replication status.

183. What is Shadow Principal?

Shadow principals manage cross-forest permissions. They simplify access control.

184. What is ADMT?

ADMT migrates users and computers. It supports domain migration.

185. What is SIDHistory Risk?

SIDHistory can be abused for privilege escalation. It should be cleaned after migration.

186. What is WSMAN?

WSMAN is a management protocol. It enables remote management.

187. What is WinRM?

WinRM enables PowerShell remoting. It supports automation.

188. What is Event ID 4625?

Event ID 4625 indicates a failed login attempt. It helps detect attacks.

189. What is Event ID 4624?

Event ID 4624 indicates successful login. It tracks access.

190. What is Account Lockout Policy?

Lockout policy controls failed attempts. It prevents brute-force attacks.

191. What is Local Security Policy?

Local Security Policy defines system-level settings. It controls authentication and auditing.

192. What is Secpol.msc?

Secpol.msc opens Local Security Policy console. It manages security settings.

193. What is UPN?

UPN is User Principal Name. It defines the login format.

194. What is SPN?

SPN identifies services in Kerberos. It enables authentication.

195. What is Kerberos Delegation?

Delegation allows services to act on behalf of users. It must be configured securely.

196. What is Constrained Delegation?

Constrained delegation limits service access. It reduces security risk.

197. What is Resource-Based Delegation?

It allows service control at the resource level. It improves security.

198. What is GMSA?

GMSA is Group Managed Service Account. It manages service passwords automatically.

199. What is the Benefit of GMSA?

Passwords rotate automatically. It improves security.

200. What is Event ID 4740?

Event ID 4740 indicates account lockout. It helps detect attacks.

ADVANCED INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

201. What is Privileged Access Management (PAM)?

Privileged Access Management controls and monitors administrative access. It helps reduce security risks by limiting excessive privileges.

202. What is Just-In-Time (JIT) Administration?

JIT provides temporary administrative access. Privileges are removed automatically after a defined time.

203. What are Tier 0 assets?

Tier 0 assets include Domain Controllers and critical AD components. Compromise of Tier 0 can lead to full domain takeover.

204. What are Tier 1 assets?

Tier 1 assets include servers and applications. They support business services.

205. What are Tier 2 assets?

Tier 2 assets include user workstations. They have the lowest privilege level.

206. What is Active Directory Hardening?

AD hardening improves security by reducing attack surfaces. It includes disabling legacy protocols and enforcing strong policies.

207. What is a Golden Ticket attack?

Golden Ticket uses a compromised Kerberos key to create fake tickets. It provides persistent domain access.

208. What is a Silver Ticket attack?

Silver Ticket targets service accounts. It allows attackers to access specific services.

209. How can Kerberos be secured?

Kerberos is secured by strong passwords and time synchronization. Monitoring authentication logs is also important.

210. What is Credential Guard?

Credential Guard isolates credentials using virtualization-based security. It prevents credential theft.

211. What is LSASS?

LSASS manages authentication and security policies. It stores sensitive credentials in memory.

212. Why should LSASS be protected?

LSASS protection prevents credential dumping. It reduces the risk of Pass-the-Hash attacks.

213. What is a Pass-the-Hash attack?

Pass-the-Hash uses stolen password hashes. Attackers authenticate without knowing the actual password.

214. What is NTDS.dit?

NTDS.dit is the Active Directory database file. It stores user credentials and directory data.

215. How can NTDS.dit be secured?

Access to NTDS.dit should be restricted. Regular monitoring and encryption help protect it.

216. What is Active Directory Certificate Services (AD CS)?

AD CS provides public key infrastructure. It issues and manages digital certificates.

217. What is a Certificate Revocation List (CRL)?

CRL lists revoked certificates. Clients check it to ensure certificate validity.

218. What is OCSP?

OCSP provides real-time certificate validation. It reduces reliance on CRLs.

219. What is a Shielded Virtual Machine?

Shielded VMs protect sensitive workloads. They encrypt VM data and prevent unauthorized access.

220. What is Host Guardian Service (HGS)?

HGS validates hosts running shielded VMs. It ensures only trusted hosts can run protected VMs.

221. What is Failover Clustering?

Failover clustering provides high availability. Services move automatically during failures.

222. What is Cluster Shared Volume (CSV)?

CSV allows multiple nodes to access shared storage. It is used for Hyper-V clusters.

223. What is a Witness Disk?

A witness disk participates in quorum voting. It helps maintain cluster stability.

224. What is Quorum?

Quorum determines cluster availability. It prevents split-brain scenarios.

225. What is Storage Replica?

Storage Replica replicates volumes between servers. It supports disaster recovery.

226. Difference between synchronous and asynchronous replication?

Synchronous replication ensures zero data loss. Asynchronous replication allows some latency.

227. What is Storage Spaces Direct (S2D)?

S2D pools local disks into shared storage. It enables software-defined storage.

228. What is Azure Hybrid Benefit?

Azure Hybrid Benefit reduces licensing costs. It allows reuse of on-prem licenses.

229. What is Azure Arc?

Azure Arc manages on-prem and cloud resources. It provides centralized control.

230. What is Windows Admin Center Gateway?

It provides centralized management access. It secures server connections.

231. What is a Group Managed Service Account (GMSA)?

GMSA manages service account passwords automatically. It improves security.

232. Why is GMSA better than standard service accounts?

Passwords rotate automatically. It reduces manual management.

233. What is Resource-Based Constrained Delegation?

It controls delegation at the resource level. It improves security over traditional delegation.

234. What is SIEM integration?

SIEM integration centralizes logs. It enables security analysis.

235. What is Event ID 4768?

Event ID 4768 logs Kerberos authentication requests. It helps monitor login attempts.

236. What is Event ID 4740?

Event ID 4740 indicates account lockouts. It helps detect brute-force attacks.

237. What is Forest Recovery?

Forest recovery restores entire AD forest. It is used after major failures.

238. What is a Disaster Recovery (DR) site?

A DR site hosts backup systems. It ensures business continuity.

239. What is Recovery Time Objective (RTO)?

RTO defines acceptable downtime. It measures recovery speed.

240. What is Recovery Point Objective (RPO)?

RPO defines acceptable data loss. It measures backup frequency.

241. What is WinDbg?

WinDbg is a debugging tool. It analyzes crash dumps.

242. What is a Memory Dump?

Memory dump captures system state during crashes. It helps troubleshooting.

243. What is Latency Monitoring?

Latency monitoring measures response delays. It helps performance tuning.

244. What is a Performance Baseline?

Baseline defines normal performance metrics. It helps detect issues.

245. What is Zero Trust Security Model?

Zero Trust assumes no trust by default. Every access is verified.

246. What is Conditional Access?

Conditional access enforces access policies. It uses conditions like location or device.

247. What is Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)?

MFA requires multiple authentication factors. It improves security.

248. What is Microsoft Defender for Identity?

Defender for Identity detects AD threats. It monitors suspicious activities.

249. What is Attack Path Analysis?

Attack path analysis identifies privilege escalation paths. It helps mitigate risks.

250. What is an Insider Threat?

Insider threats come from internal users. They pose serious security risks.

251. What is Compliance Auditing?

Compliance auditing checks policy adherence. It ensures regulatory compliance.

252. What are SOX and ISO standards?

SOX and ISO define security and compliance standards. They ensure best practices.

253. What is Change Management?

Change management controls system changes. It reduces risks.

254. What is a Change Advisory Board (CAB)?

CAB reviews change requests. It approves or rejects changes.

255. What is Maintenance Mode?

Maintenance mode suspends alerts during updates. It prevents false alarms.

256. What is Blue Team?

Blue Team focuses on defense. They monitor and protect systems.

257. What is Red Team?

Red Team simulates attacks. They test security readiness.

258. What is Purple Team?

Purple Team combines Blue and Red efforts. It improves security collaboration.

259. What is a Hardening Baseline?

A hardening baseline defines secure configurations. It standardizes security.

260. What is CIS Benchmark?

CIS Benchmark provides security guidelines. It is widely used.

261. What is Least Privilege Enforcement?

It ensures minimal access rights. It reduces attack impact.

262. What is an Audit Trail?

Audit trail records system activities. It helps investigations.

263. What is Log Retention Policy?

Log retention defines log storage duration. It supports compliance.

264. What is Sysmon?

Sysmon provides advanced logging. It enhances threat detection.

265. What is PowerShell Remoting?

PowerShell remoting executes commands remotely. It supports automation.

266. What is Constrained Language Mode?

It restricts PowerShell capabilities. It prevents malicious scripts.

267. What is Script Block Logging?

Script block logging records script execution. It improves visibility.

268. What is Attack Surface Analyzer?

It identifies security exposure. It helps reduce vulnerabilities.

269. What is Credential Roaming?

Credential roaming syncs user certificates. It simplifies access.

270. What is Token-Based Authentication?

Token-based authentication uses secure tokens. It reduces password exposure.

271. What is Kerberos Delegation Risk?

Delegation can be abused. Proper configuration is essential.

272. What is AdminSDHolder?

AdminSDHolder protects privileged accounts. It enforces permissions.

273. What is SDProp?

SDProp updates permissions regularly. It ensures security consistency.

274. What is a DC Shadow Attack?

DC Shadow simulates a fake DC. It injects malicious changes.

275. What is LDAP Signing?

LDAP signing secures directory communication. It prevents MITM attacks.

276. What is LDAP Channel Binding?

It validates secure LDAP connections. It enhances security.

277. What is SMB Encryption?

SMB encryption secures file transfers. It protects data in transit.

278. What is Network Segmentation?

Segmentation isolates network traffic. It limits attack spread.

279. What is East-West Traffic?

East-West traffic is internal network traffic. It needs monitoring.

280. What is Microsegmentation?

Microsegmentation enforces fine-grained controls. It improves security.

281. What is a Bastion Host?

A bastion host provides secure admin access. It reduces exposure.

282. What is a Jump Server?

A jump server acts as an access gateway. It enhances security.

283. What is Credential Hygiene?

Credential hygiene ensures secure password practices. It reduces risk.

284. What is a Password Spray Attack?

Password spraying uses common passwords. It avoids lockouts.

285. What is Account Lockout Best Practice?

Balanced lockout policies prevent attacks. They avoid user disruption.

286. What is Domain Controller Monitoring?

DC monitoring tracks health and performance. It ensures availability.

287. What is Health Check Automation?

Automation runs regular diagnostics. It detects issues early.

288. What is Immutable Backup?

Immutable backups cannot be altered. They protect against ransomware.

289. What is Ransomware Protection Strategy?

It combines backups and monitoring. It reduces impact.

290. What is Attack Simulation Training?

Simulation trains users against threats. It improves awareness.

291. What is an Incident Response Plan?

It defines steps during attacks. It minimizes damage.

292. What is Forensic Analysis?

Forensic analysis investigates incidents. It identifies root cause.

293. What is Root Cause Analysis?

It finds underlying issues. It prevents recurrence.

294. What is Service Level Agreement (SLA)?

SLA defines service expectations. It ensures accountability.

295. What is Site Reliability Engineering (SRE)?

SRE focuses on system reliability. It blends development and operations.

296. High Availability vs Disaster Recovery?

High availability prevents downtime. Disaster recovery restores systems.

297. What is Server Decommissioning?

Decommissioning removes servers securely. It prevents data leaks.

298. What is Data Classification?

Data classification labels data sensitivity. It helps protection.

299. What is Compliance Reporting?

Compliance reporting documents adherence. It supports audits.

300. What is an Enterprise Hardening Strategy?

Enterprise hardening secures systems organization-wide. It enforces consistent security controls.